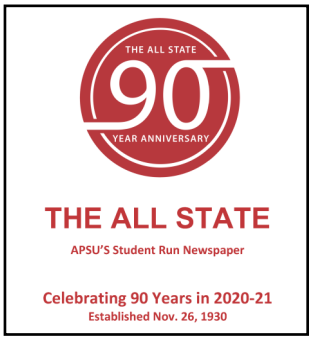
The Woodward Library Society Newsletter

WINTER 2021

What's New?

Call for Board Members

The Woodward Library Society Board of Directors is responsible for the overall direction and administration of the organization. Open positions include vice president/president-elect, secretary, treasurer, and three directors. If you are interested in serving in any of these capacities, please contact Vice President Tracy Nichols, or Director of Library Services Joe Weber.



The All State's 90th Year

Austin Peay's student-run newspaper, The All State, is celebrating its 90th year. With the help of Director of Student Affairs Programs and Assessment Tammy Bryant, the Woodward Library Display Committee created a display to showcase the newspaper's achievements over the years. Felix G. Woodward was one of the original sponsors of the newspaper.

Voting in Belize

APSU political science professor and Society Board member Dr. Harry Young was interviewed for a piece about voting in Belize. Dr. Young said Belize has a voter turnout of almost 80 percent. The article walks you through the voting process in Belize and what happened after the polls closed. You can read the full article here: APSU political science professor compares elections in U.S. and Belize

Spring Homecoming

The Woodward Library entered the 2021 Spring Homecoming Door Decorating contest this year. The theme was Peayce, Love, and Govs. Corina Ravenscraft designed the door and drew the main elements, and Tina Reid, Kristy Cunningham, and Alyssa Amos rounded out the creative team.

The Woodward Library Society

A non-profit organization affiliated with the Austin Peay State University Foundation
http://library.apsu.edu/society

2020-2021 Board of Directors
Stuart Bonnington, President
Tracy Nichols, Vice President
Secretary (Vacant)
Marsha Lyle-Gonga, Treasurer
Nick Tooley, Past President
Bobette Bouton, Director
Dewey Browder, Director
Andrea Goble, Director
Amelia Allen Hartz, Director
Walt Lord, Director
Harry Young, Director
Mercy Cannon, ex-officio
Christina Chester-Fangman, ex-officio
Jerica Swiger, ex-officio
Joe Weber, ex-officio

Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion at the Woodward Library

The development of the Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion statement was the first task of the Library's Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Committee. Ellen Brown and Jenny Harris co-chair the committee, and Christina Chester-Fangman, Nancy Gibson, Tina Reid, Scott Shumate, and Nicole Wood make up the rest of the team.

The motivation for writing this statement and forming the committee was to:

- openly communicate our commitment to diversity, equity, and inclusion
- raise awareness and support the intentional examination of library initiatives
- strategize and create an action plan to improve our spaces and services
- better support all members of the library
- recognize and remove obstacles for members of our community who have experienced discrimination or exclusion
- provide a framework for ongoing reflection and evaluation of library spaces, services, and resources

The final draft of the Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion statement was sent to APSU's Chief Diversity Officer LaNeeça Williams for her review before publication on the Library's website. "Libraries have a long history of offering information resources and programs encompassing a variety of diverse viewpoints," said Director Joe Weber. "The creation of the Library DEI Committee formalizes our commitment to supporting the values of equity, diversity and inclusion."

Librarian Spotlight

Ellen Brown moved to Clarksville in 2017 when she began her career at the Woodward Library. Before that, she lived in Knoxville where she attended the University of Tennessee and earned an M.S. in information sciences in 2015, and an M.S. in chemistry with a computational science minor in 2011. She earned a B.S. in biochemistry from the University of North Carolina at Asheville in 2007.

Currently, Ellen serves as the science librarian and works with library and classroom faculty to integrate information literacy and research skills across the curriculum. She develops instructional services for users of the library and serves as library liaison to the science and engineering departments.

In her spare time, Ellen enjoys outdoor activities and loves hiking, making maps, traveling, oceanography, and swimming. As a teenager, she was an open-water swimmer.

Ellen Recommends:

***Felicity* by Mary Oliver**

The Life Aquatic with Steve Zissou

Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Statement

The foundation of modern librarianship is based on an essential and inter-related set of core values that includes access, diversity, education and lifelong learning, intellectual freedom, and social responsibility. To that end, the Woodward Library is committed to helping achieve Austin Peay State University's mission and vision of educating informed global citizens by:

- creating a welcoming environment that is conducive to exploration, learning, and research for all users;
- providing access to content that represents diverse voices and viewpoints.

Further, we recognize that we are members of an inclusive campus community and everyone employed by the Woodward Library has a responsibility to treat coworkers, faculty, staff, students, and other users with respect and dignity regardless of ability, age, ethnicity, gender, gender expression, gender identity, genetic information, national origin, political views, race, religion, sex, sexual orientation, or veteran status.

In order to advocate for our diverse users and to provide active, intentional, and ongoing engagement to foster diversity initiatives, the Woodward Library will:

- enhance the experience of all Library users by maintaining inclusive, safe, and welcoming library spaces.
- provide content, collections, resources, services, programs, events, and exhibits that support diversity, equity, and a sense of belonging.
- maintain strong relationships with APSU's diverse communities -- including but not limited to cultural and identity groups (BIPOC, LGBTQIA+), first-generation students, low-income students, post-traditional students, military-affiliated students, and international students -- and the programs that support them.
- work in concert with APSU's Office of Equity, Access, & Inclusion to facilitate professional development training and support for all Library employees in understanding and developing cultural competencies.
- work with APSU's Offices of Human Resources and Equity, Access, & Inclusion to utilize hiring practices that will allow our Library employees to reflect the diverse communities we serve.

— Inspired by statements from Austin Peay State University's College of Arts and Letters, the American Library Association, Morris Library-Southern Illinois University, and California State University Monterey Bay